

Hackathon Experience

Project: NeuroCrowd – AI-Based Real-Time Crowd Intelligence And Risk Prediction System

Event: 36-Hour Hackathon – NIT Tiruchirappalli

Our Hackathon Journey

Participating in the 36-Hour Hackathon at NIT Tiruchirappalli was an exciting and challenging experience for our team. We entered the competition with the idea of building an AI-powered crowd safety system that could help prevent accidents in large public gatherings by predicting crowd risk in real time.

During the hackathon, we worked continuously to transform our idea into a functional prototype. We explored different approaches for person detection, crowd analysis, and risk prediction while learning new technologies along the way. We improved our detection accuracy by experimenting with different YOLOv8 models, optimized our application using GPU acceleration, and integrated multiple AI techniques to make our system more reliable.

One of the biggest challenges we faced was balancing speed and accuracy while working within the limited hackathon time. Debugging the system, improving prediction quality, and integrating different modules required constant teamwork, communication, and problem-solving.

Beyond the technical learning, this hackathon taught us the importance of collaboration, time management, and rapid prototyping. Working under continuous deadlines helped us make quick decisions, divide responsibilities effectively, and stay focused on building a meaningful solution.

Overall, this experience strengthened both our technical and teamwork skills, and motivated us to continue improving NeuroCrowd into a practical solution that can contribute to public safety in real-world environments.